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Please write clearly in block capitals.

Centre number | | | | | |

Candidate number | | | | |

Surname

Forename(s)

Candidate signature

English Language

Paper 2 Section A: Writers' viewpoints and perspectives (reading)

Suggested time: about 1 hour. There is no timer.

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- a black pen
- Source A and Source B, printed on the next pages

Instructions

- Answer all questions.
- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- You must refer to the sources in your answers.
- Read both sources and all four questions before you start.

Information

- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- The maximum mark for this paper is 40.
- This practice paper covers Section A only. The real Paper 2 also has Section B (writing, 40 marks).

For Examiner's Use	
Question	**Mark**
1	
2	
3	
4	
TOTAL	

This is a practice paper written for Dougie in the style of the GCSE exam. Both sources were written for this paper. It is not an exam board paper, and it is not a paper from any past exam series.

Source A

Source A is a blog post written for this practice paper. Its writer, Amira, is twelve and has just finished her first week at secondary school.

Nobody tells you that secondary school is basically a small town. On my first morning I stood at the gates with eleven hundred other people, and every single one of them seemed to know exactly where they were going. The Year 11s looked about thirty. One of them had a beard. I had a new blazer two sizes too big, because Mum said I would "grow into it", and a timetable folded so many times it had gone soft, like a tissue.

The building is enormous. There are three floors, two canteens and a sports hall with a climbing wall, which I have not been brave enough to try yet. The corridors all look the same, and the room numbers make no sense: room 214 is nowhere near room 213. On Tuesday I walked into a Year 9 French lesson by mistake and had to walk straight back out again while thirty people stared at me. I wanted the floor to swallow me up.

But on Wednesday I found out something nobody tells you: everyone is lost at the start. I met a girl called Maisie who was just as lost as me, and we decided to be lost together.

Lunch is the best part of the day. You pay with your thumbprint, which feels like something out of a spy film, and there is a choice of pizza, pasta, curry or a "build your own" wrap. Nobody makes you finish your vegetables. Nobody makes you do anything, really, as long as you turn up on time and have the right book. The teachers call you by your first name and some of them even make jokes, although not very good ones.

My form tutor, Mr Okafor, told us on the first day that the school's job was to help us find out what we are good at. "Nobody here is expecting you to be perfect," he said. "We're expecting you to try." I wrote that down in the back of my planner, because I think I will need it.

I am not going to pretend it has all been easy. I cried on Monday night, mostly because I was tired, and partly because I had lost my PE kit. My feet hurt from all the stairs. I miss my primary school, where everyone knew my name and the biggest worry was who got to feed the class hamster.

But on Friday, Maisie and I tried the climbing wall. I got about halfway up before my arms gave out, and when I came down, a Year 8 I had never met said, "Not bad for a first go." I walked home feeling about ten feet tall. Big school is big. But it turns out I am not as small as I thought.

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Source B

Source B is a letter written for this practice paper in the style of the 1850s. It imagines a boy of twelve, Edward, writing home to his mother in his first week at boarding school.

My dearest Mother,

I write to you by the light of a single candle, which Mr Hargreaves permits us for one quarter of an hour before the bell. I hope this letter finds you and Papa in good health, and that little Alice has quite recovered from her cold. I am well, though I confess I have been colder this week than at any time in my life.

The school is a great grey building upon a hill, and the wind finds its way through every window. Our dormitory holds thirty boys in two long rows of iron beds, and there is but one fire, which is never lit before November. In the mornings the water in the wash-basins is often skinned with ice, and we must break it with our fists before we wash.

We rise at six by the bell, and woe betide the boy who is late, for he must go without his breakfast. I have not yet been late.

Our breakfast is bread and a thin porridge, and our dinner, for the most part, is mutton, which is grey and tough and comes with potatoes that have been boiled until they have quite given up. We are expected to eat every scrap in silence. On Sunday there was a pudding, and I believe I have never been so grateful for anything in all my days.

The masters are strict, as Papa said they would be. Mr Hargreaves keeps a cane upon his desk, and on Thursday he used it upon a boy named Fletcher, who had blotted his copy-book. Fletcher did not cry out, and we all thought him very brave. I am resolved to keep my copy-book clean.

We learn Latin and Greek each morning, and arithmetic after dinner, and in the evenings we learn our verses by heart. It is very hard, but Mr Hargreaves says that hardship makes a man of a boy, and I am determined that you and Papa shall be proud of me.

I will not pretend, dear Mother, that I do not sometimes think of home, and of the kitchen fire, and of your voice reading to us of an evening. But I know that Papa sent me here for my own good, and I mean to bear it as a gentleman should. Please do not worry for me.

The bell is ringing and the candle is almost gone.

Your loving son,

Edward

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Section A: Reading

Answer all questions in this section. You are advised to spend about 50 minutes on this section, after about 10 minutes reading the sources and the questions.

0 1 Read again Source A from lines 1 to 15. Choose four statements below which are true.
Shade the circles in the boxes of the ones you think are true. Choose a maximum of four statements.

A	Amira started secondary school with about eleven hundred other people.	◯
B	Amira's new blazer fitted her perfectly.	◯
C	Amira's timetable had been folded many times.	◯
D	The school has two canteens.	◯
E	Amira has already climbed the climbing wall.	◯
F	Room 214 is next to room 213.	◯
G	Amira walked into a Year 9 French lesson by mistake.	◯
H	Amira met Maisie on her first morning.	◯

[4 marks]

0 2 You need to refer to Source A and Source B for this question. Use details from both sources. Write a summary of the differences between the food at Amira's school and the food at Edward's school.

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[8 marks]

0 3 You now need to refer only to Source B, lines 7 to 13. How does the writer use language to describe the school?

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[12 marks]

0 4 For this question, you need to refer to the whole of Source A, together with the whole of Source B. Compare how the writers convey their different feelings about starting at a new school.

In your answer, you could: compare their different feelings; compare the methods the writers use to convey their feelings; support your response with references to both texts.

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[16 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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